

Kali Linux installation guide

You can install Kali Linux as a usual operating system (OS) on your computer or dual boot with your existing OS. This is more advanced and only recommended if you want native speeds and don't need another OS. Having it as a Virtual Machine (VM) is easiest and brings other benefits. Using a VM makes it easier to separate files and tools from your regular OS, and to reinstall Kali if (read: when) stuff breaks.

This walkthrough is focused on Windows, very similar steps are taken in Linux. See separate guide for Mac.

Hardware Prerequisites (for your desktop or laptop:

- Minimum: ~20 GB disk space , 8 GB ram
- Recommended ~40-80 GB GB disk space, 16 GB ram

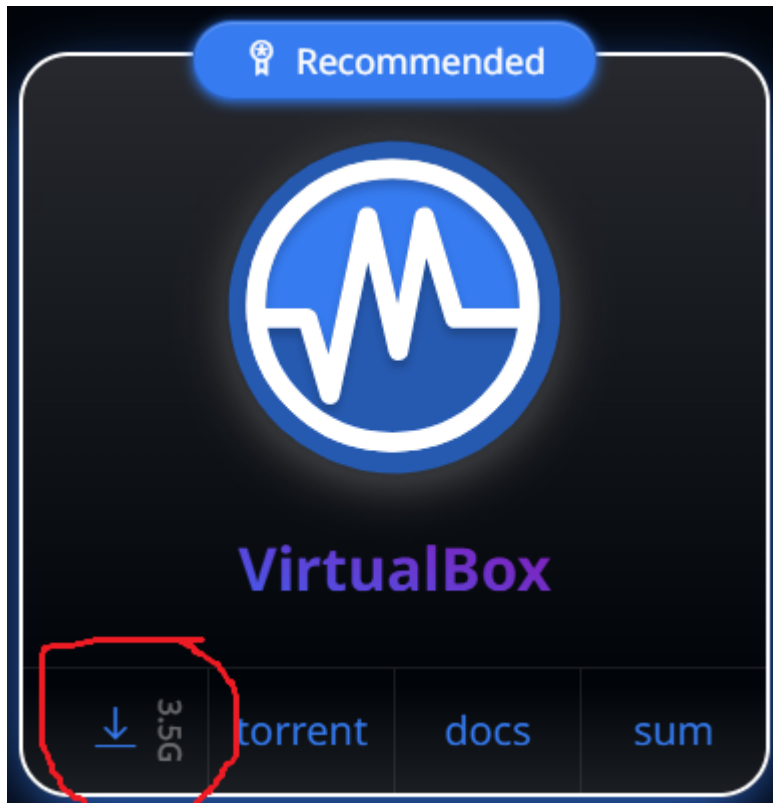
Step 1: Download software

In order to create a VM on your machine, you need a *hypervisor*. There are several alternatives that work with Kali, but for this guide we will use Virtualbox.

- Download VirtualBox from <https://www.virtualbox.org/wiki/Downloads>



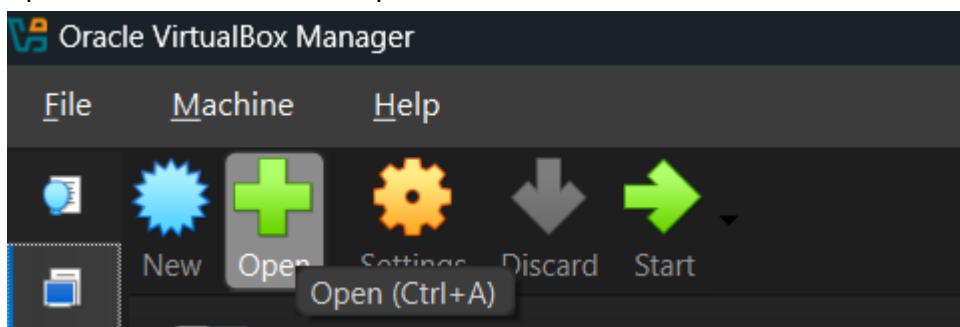
- Download the corresponding Kali Linux VM file from <https://www.kali.org/get-kali/#kali-virtual-machines>



- After downloading you should have a file named “kali-linux-2025.4-virtualbox-amd64.7z” or similar in your Downloads folder.
- Unzip (extract) this file. This can take several minutes.

Step 2: Install the Kali Virtual Machine

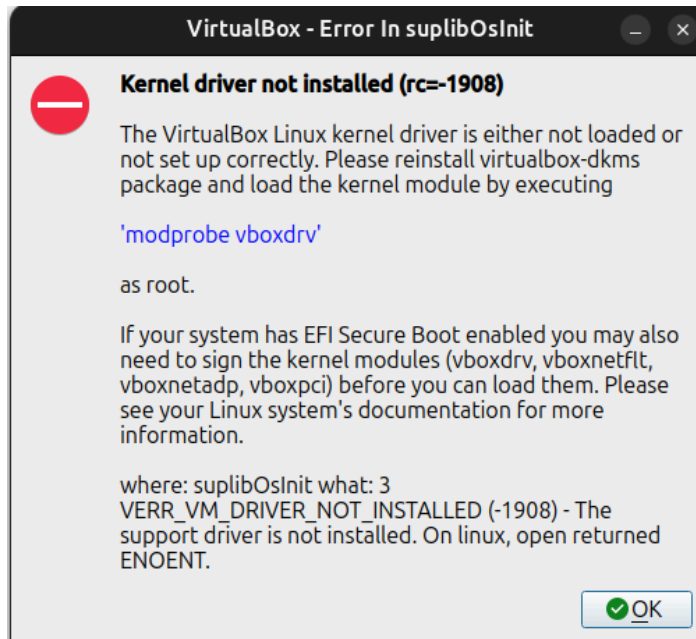
- Open Virtualbox and click “Open”



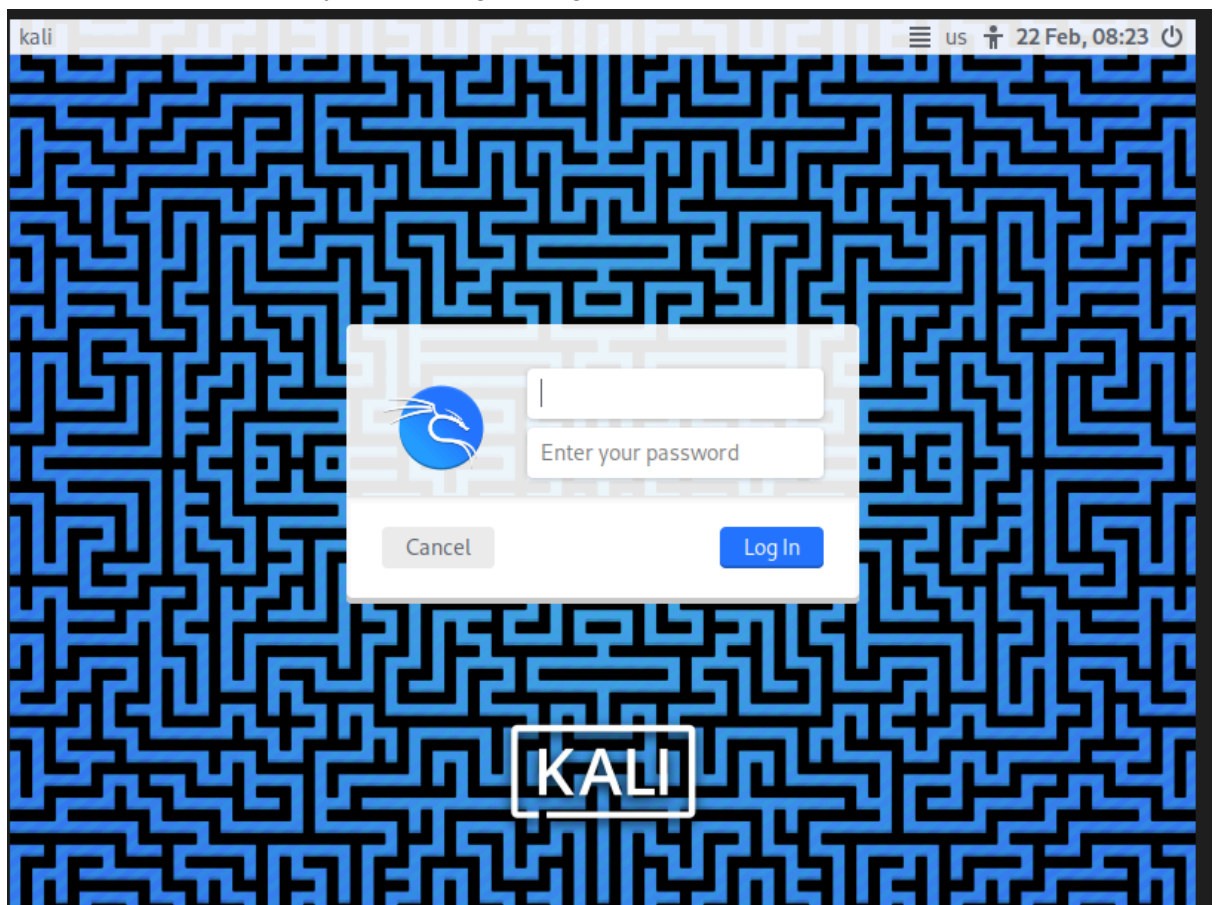
- Select the Kali .vbox file that you downloaded earlier
- Double click the newly added VM to start it:



- **Linux (Debian):** You might encounter this error when trying to start the VM. If this happens, install the virtualbox-dkms package with “sudo apt install virtualbox-dkms” and “sudo modprobe vboxdrv” as the error says. After this has been done, try to start the VM again.



- Wait a few minutes, and you should get a login prompt:

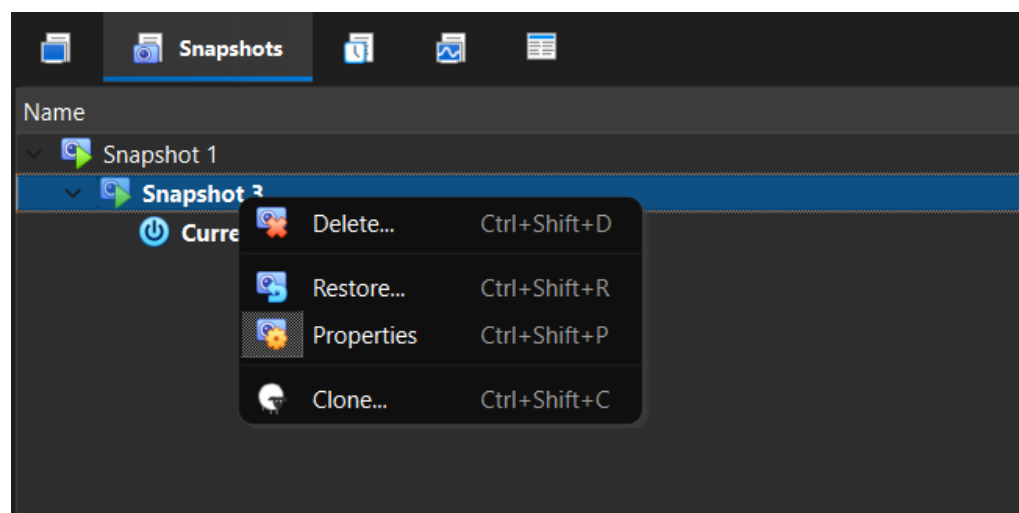


- The default credentials are:
 - **Username:** kali
 - **Password:** kali
- Now you have a basic installation of a Kali VM!

- At this point your Kali VM is installed and ready to use. Although there are several configuration steps after that make your experience better.

Step 3: Configuration

- Snapshotting
 - Creates a rollback point for your VM.
 - This is a good thing to do before proceeding with any configuration, should something fail.
 - While the VM is running: Click “Machine”->”Take snapshot” in the top toolbar.
 - Give it a name and wait a little bit.
 - To rollback: Shutdown the VM, right click the snapshot that you want to rollback to in Virtualbox and select “Restore”:



- (Note: when performing these steps there is a risk that the Kali VM hangs and breaks. When this happens remove the Kali VM in Virtualbox and repeat Step 2, if a rollback doesn't help)
- Install Guest Additions
 - This enables host-VM features such as shared folders, copy-paste into/out of the VM.
 - *Should* be installed by default
 - Run this in order to ensure that it is correctly installed:
 - `sudo apt update`
 - `sudo apt install -y --reinstall virtualbox-guest-x11`
 - `sudo reboot -f`
- Change keyboard layout (English->Swedish)
 - Search for “Keyboard” in the Kali menu
 - Go to “Layout”, click “Add” under “Keyboard layout”
 - Select “Swedish” or the layout you prefer and click “OK”
 - If you do not want the English layout. Select the English layout under “Keyboard layout” and remove it.
 - You should now have the correct keyboard layout, otherwise try a restart.
- Increase/decrease RAM usage in Virtualbox:
 - Right click your VM and choose “Settings”

- Change the RAM usage under “System”->“Motherboard”->“Base Memory” to what you want.
 - You can also change the number of cores used under “System”->“Processor”.
- Increase disk usage in Virtualbox:
 - Select “File”->“Tools”->“Media”
 - Select the .vdi file that corresponds to your VM
 - Now you can increase the size by entering the desired value at the bottom
 - Note: Decreasing disk usage is not supported
- (optional) Run the following command to make sure everything is up to date (**Warning:** will take a while):
 - `sudo apt update -y && sudo apt upgrade -y`